

computer monitors'. Consider the type of presentations you'll make using it. For PowerPoint slides and simple clear graphics, choose SVGA. For spreadsheets and more detailed graphics, choose XGA. For large screens too, choose XGA.

Mini projectors don't offer native widescreen resolutions. Also, these are usually limited in the range of resolutions that they can accept and then scale down to their native resolution.

Contrast ratio. Contrast ratio is the ratio between the brightest and darkest areas of the image. A higher contrast ratio means sharper and crisper pictures. But given the low brightness levels of mini projectors, the contrast ratio for them matters even less than for conventional projectors.

Connectivity. Check out the connectivity to various devices like the monitor, desktop PC and DVD player. Explore what and how many ports are available. Also check USB and wireless

connectivity (can you wirelessly connect a PC to the projector?).

A pico projector has basic connectivity options, whereas palm projectors will have connectivity ports for laptop/PC, DTH, home theatre, gaming devices, etc.

Audio capabilities. If you will use the projector for audio-visual presentations or watching movies, ensure that the audio is both high-quality and loud enough to meet your needs. If you move a lot, a built-in speaker system is recommended. In case you need extra loudness, you should be able to connect additional speakers to the projector. Also look for audio inputs

Lamp. Check out how many hours of viewing the projector's lamp can last. The longer it is, the less frequently you need to replace it.

Other features. Auto features will help you save on time and get started with your presentation or home movies right away. Auto focus is very

helpful. Otherwise, you will spend a lot of time adjusting the focus. Trapezoidal correction is another feature to look for. The projected image at times is trapezoidal in shape. The projector should have the capability to correct that. Wall colour can differ from location to location, so look out for wall-colour correction. A file viewer option would allow you to view Microsoft PowerPoint, Excel and Word files directly from the projector through the USB port.

Final word

Before buying a mini projector, consider the usage scenario. If you want a complete home theatre experience and have a large drawing room suitable for that, you will not be satisfied with the performance of a mini projector. And if you make up your mind to buy one, buy only from the right source after ensuring good after-sales support. ●

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